

China on the ground – July 2026

Key words: AI and tech

Our monthly series provides investors with first-hand, on-the-ground knowledge on China by leveraging UBS's extensive onshore coverage and presence. In addition to feedback from various field trips UBS conducted in China, we present a sector heat map based on company visits and crowding factors from UBS's Quant team.

Made in China for the world

We organised a tech tour and met 12 companies along with 40 investors. The tour showcased rapid progresses in China LLM iteration and domestic AI infrastructure offerings. Combined with positive feedback on AI end demand, we are more positive on China's AI tech space. Based on our company visits, **semi & semi caps** had the largest increase in investor meetings/visit share in July, while **capital goods** posted the largest decline. According to UBS's China Corporate Access team, the **tech, materials** and **consumer** sectors in China led investor visits in July 2026 (**vs. tech, auto** and **materials** in Q226), and the companies investors wanted to meet the most were NAURA ([China's aggressive memory capex and WFE localization intact](#)), Xiaomi, AMEC, Minimax, Jiaxin International, Han's Laser, Zhongtian Tech, Weichai Power, Xingyu Lighting and Meituan.

Major trips

Tech. We hosted UBS's World Artificial Intelligence Conference (WAIC) 2026 Tech Tour, and held C-level/IR meetings with 12 companies working in LLM (MiniMax, Zhipu, Phancy and Xunce), GPU (Biren), networking (Montage and Xizhi), analog (Southchip and Dosilicon), OSAT (JCET), ODM (Huaqin) and semi equipment (PowerTech). We made multiple booth visits and attended keynote events. Notable takeaways: 1) global collaboration: China announced the creation of WAICO (World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organization), involving 29 countries and signed initiatives on AI governance. China signed cUS\$3bn of new contracts with overseas companies; 2) rapid progress in China LLM iteration, including Kimi K3 and Qwen 3.8-Max models; 3) evolving domestic AI infrastructure offerings including super computing (e.g. Biren), SuperPod (e.g. Huawei, Huaqin) and networking (e.g. Xizhi); and 4) positive feedback from the supply chain on AI infra-related end demand. The tour strengthened our confidence and improved visibility on the rapid growth of China's major AI tech supply chain companies in 2026E and beyond.

Utilities. We visited Sungrow's office in Hefei. The three key takeaways are: 1) management is positive on the progress of SST (solid state transformers) development and expects to launch a product in the next few months; 2) the company has been selling AIDC BESS to developers/integrators since Q126, who sell them on to US CSPs (Cloud Service Providers), and was positive on the outlook for US BESS demand; and 3) management is cautious on margins for the BESS business as it is expanding in low-margin markets. It said Q226 GPM could remain under pressure due to lithium price hikes.

Heat map: Semi popular; capital goods fading

Leveraging company visit data and crowding factors from UBS's Quant Research team, we gauge shifts in investor interest among sectors. In July, the top three sectors gaining investor meeting/visit share among overall company visits were **semi & semi cap, tech hardware** and **banks**. In addition, based on UBS Quant's proprietary crowding factor data, **software & services** appear uncrowded while recording MoM increases in company visits. Conversely, **materials, food, beverage & tobacco**, and **capital goods** recorded the largest decline in company visits with crowding factor tilted to the long side in July.

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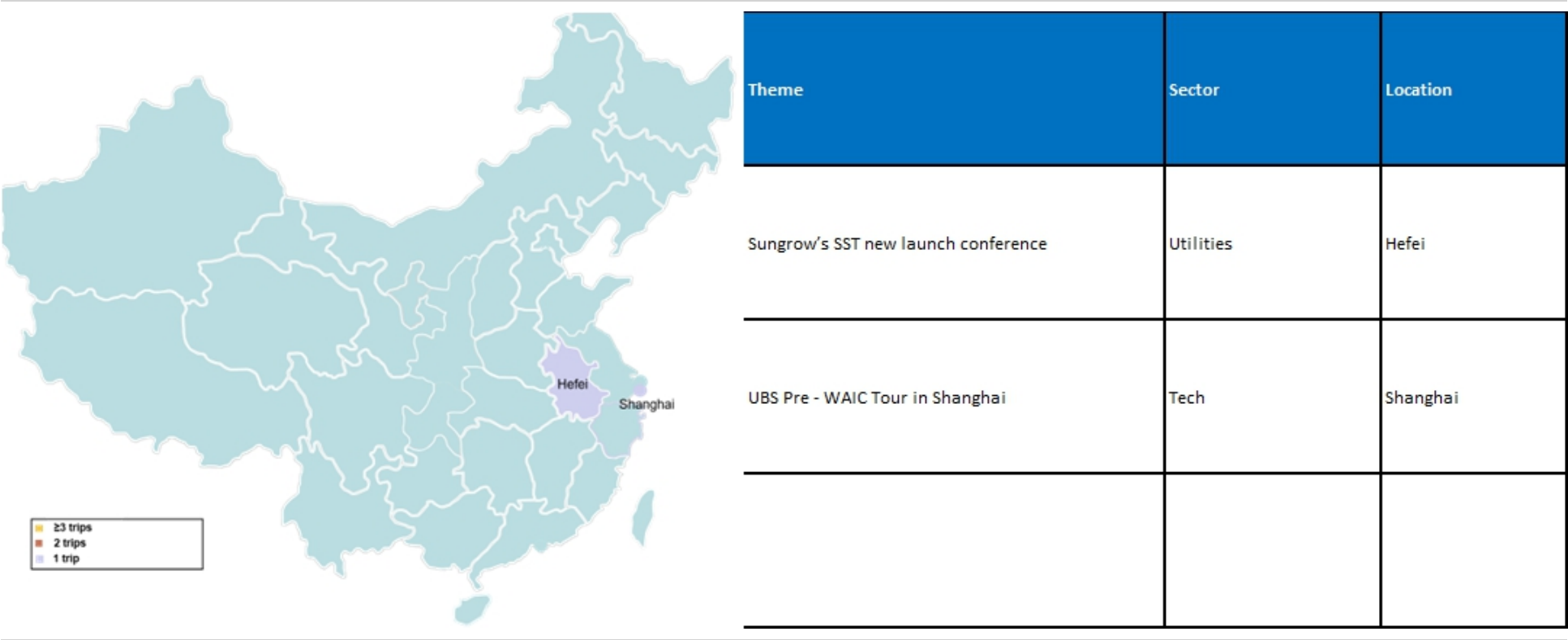
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Figure 1: UBS China team's on-the-ground visits in July

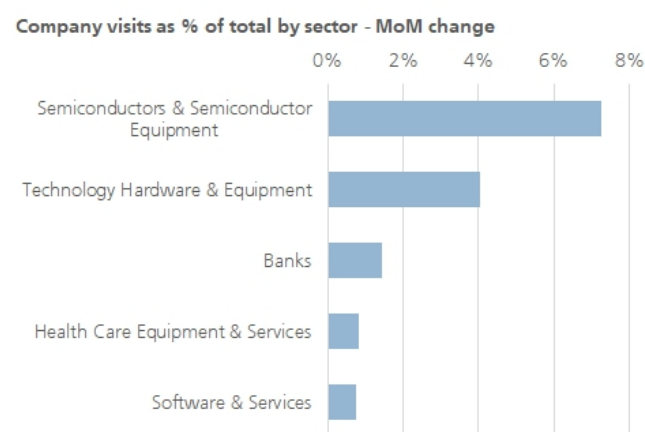


Source: UBS-S

Sector heat map

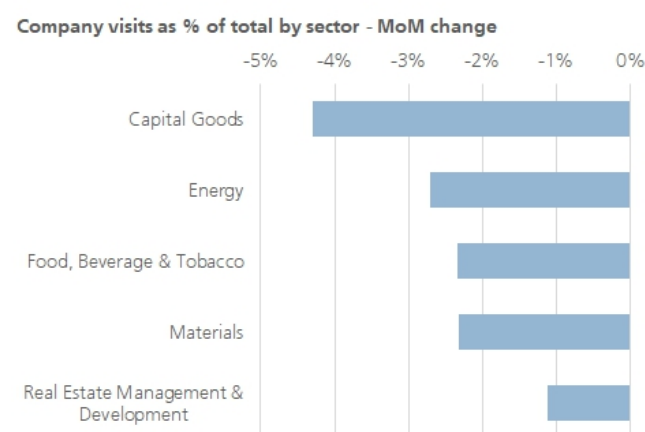
UBS's Quant Research team provides an institutional field trip dataset for A-share companies, which we view as a useful broad indicator of investor interest in specific companies/sectors. We aggregate the number of visits to a single company at the sector level and calculate the share of each sector. We track the MoM change in each sector's investor visit share, which we believe indicates shifts in investor interest among sectors. In July, **semi & semi equipment**, **tech hardware & equipment** and **banks** recorded the highest proportional MoM increases in company visits, while **capital goods**, **energy**, **food, beverage & tobacco** recorded the highest proportional decreases.

Figure 2: Top five sectors with highest proportional MoM company visit increases



Source: UBS Quant Research

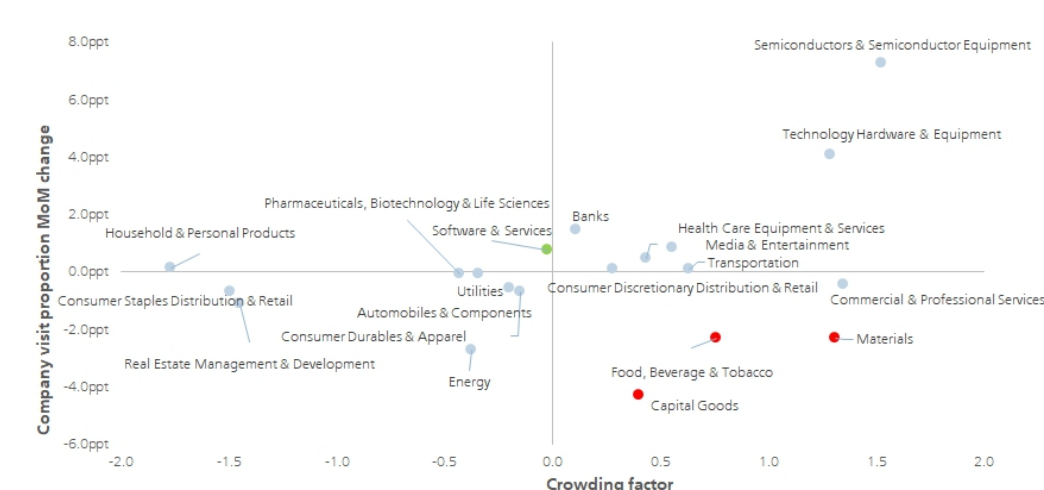
Figure 3: Bottom five sectors with the highest proportional MoM company visit declines



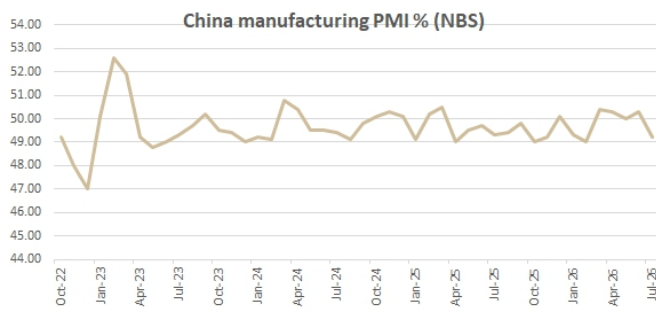
Source: UBS Quant Research

We further combine the company visit data with the crowding factor (proprietary data from UBS's Quant Research team). Crowding scores range from -30 (short-crowded) to 30 (long-crowded). In July, **software & services** recorded MoM increases in company visits and their crowding scores remained in negative territory. Conversely, **materials**, **food, beverage & tobacco**, and **capital goods**, which showed a large proportional decline in company visits, remained relatively crowded.

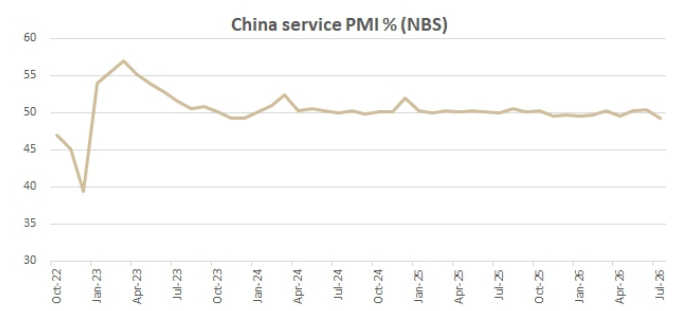
Figure 4: Company visit MoM change vs. crowding factors in June



Source: UBS Quant Research. Note: More detail on data sources and backgrounds in [A Comprehensive Crowding Factor](#) and [Can we trade on company visits in China?](#)

PMI**Figure 5: China's manufacturing PMI in July down 1.1ppt MoM**

Source: National Bureau of Statistics (NBS)

Figure 6: China's services PMI in July down 1.1ppt MoM

Source: NBS

Figure 7: China's PMI breakdown

	%	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26	Jun-26	Jul-26	MoM
Manufacturing	PMI	49.3	49.4	49.8	49.0	49.2	50.1	49.3	49.0	50.4	50.3	50.0	50.3	49.2	0.3
	New order	49.4	49.5	49.7	48.8	49.2	50.8	49.2	48.6	51.6	50.6	49.9	51.2	48.5	1.3
	New export order	47.1	47.2	47.8	45.9	47.6	49.0	47.8	45.0	49.1	50.3	48.6	50.1	49.6	1.5
	Ex-factory price	48.3	49.1	48.2	47.5	48.2	48.9	50.6	50.6	55.4	55.1	51.9	48.2	47.8	-3.7
	Employees	48.0	47.9	48.5	48.3	48.4	48.2	48.1	48.0	48.6	48.8	48.6	48.5	49.0	-0.1
	High-tech manufacturing	50.6	51.9	51.6	50.5	50.1	52.5	52.0	51.5	52.1	52.2	52.9	53.5	53.3	0.6
	Equipment manufacturing	50.3	50.5	51.9	50.2	49.8	50.4	50.1	49.8	51.5	51.8	52.1	52.5	51.4	0.4
	Consumer good	49.5	49.2	50.6	50.1	49.4	50.4	48.3	48.8	50.8	50.7	49.7	50.2	47.8	0.5
Construction	Basic material	48.0	48.2	47.5	47.3	48.4	48.9	47.9	47.8	48.9	47.9	47.1	47.1	47.0	0.0
	PMI	50.6	49.1	49.3	49.1	49.6	52.8	48.8	48.2	49.3	48.0	48.8	49.0	47.0	0.2
	New order	42.7	40.6	42.2	45.9	46.1	47.4	40.1	42.2	43.5	41.6	43.5	46.3	40.1	2.8
	Selling price	49.2	49.7	48.1	48.4	48.4	47.4	48.2	47.6	49.3	49.0	48.6	49.8	47.7	1.2
Service industry	Employees	40.9	43.6	39.7	39.9	41.8	41.0	41.1	42.5	39.1	39.6	41.4	42.3	40.9	0.9
	PMI	50.0	50.5	50.1	50.2	49.5	49.7	49.5	49.7	50.2	49.6	50.3	50.4	49.3	0.1
	New order	46.3	47.7	46.7	46.0	45.6	47.3	47.1	45.7	45.3	44.8	45.3	48.4	45.2	3.1
	Selling price	47.7	48.5	47.2	47.7	49.2	48.1	48.9	49.0	50.0	47.9	48.9	48.2	47.9	-0.7
	Employees	46.4	45.9	45.9	46.1	45.9	47.0	47.0	46.6	46.2	46.5	46.4	46.4	46.2	0.0

Source: NBS

Utilities

Sungrow (300274.SZ; Buy)

Positive on SST and AIDC, despite a cautious view on BESS margins

We visited Sungrow's office in Hefei. The three key takeaways are: 1) management is positive on the progress of SST (solid state transformers) development and expects to launch a product in the next few months; 2) the company has been selling AIDC BESS to developers/integrators since Q126, who sell them on to US CSPs (Cloud Service Providers), and was positive on the outlook for US BESS demand; and 3) management is cautious on margins for the BESS business as it is expanding in low-margin markets. It said Q226 GPM could remain under pressure due to lithium price hikes.

Promising US BESS order outlook, despite ongoing margin pressure across the BESS market

1) AIDC BESS orders. A key investor concern is the pace of AIDC BESS orders, which appear to be slower than global peers. Management said data centre projects have long lead times and BESS is one of the last items to be procured. This explains why BESS orders are slow. In addition, the company has procured AIDC BESS orders since Q126, but mainly from renewable developers and data centre developers who then resell to US CSPs. It is unlikely that CSPs will become Sungrow's direct customers. However, Sungrow has been assisting leading CSPs with R&D and validation, primarily focusing on defining the required function of the BESS system and overall power architecture. **2) US BESS shipments.** For the US market, the company expects to source from OBBB compliant ex China battery suppliers from 2027, once Korean battery makers' capacity is in place. The average selling price to the US (including AIDC orders) is around Rmb1/Wh. **3) Overall BESS margins.** Management remains cautious as the company is expanding in low-margin markets and competition is intensifying. Q226F GPM could remain under pressure due to lithium price hikes, but mgmt is positive on growth momentum for residential storage and commercial storage, benefiting from strong European and Australian demand. The company's factory in Poland could commence operations by end-2026E, which should protect Sungrow from potential EU tariffs.

Progress in SST as a long-term growth engine

The company considers its products (10kV, 2.5MW) have no technical gaps compared to global peers, and views itself as a leading domestic supplier. This is attributable to its deep understanding and technical expertise in power electronics (similar to the technology of inverters), in our view. SST product R&D is directly engaged with US CSPs, and a leading technology partner recently reviewed SST and BESS product solutions. Both SST and storage systems feature a modular design, which facilitates rapid on-site deployment and assembly, and offers significant cost advantages for installation. Management said the pace of SST adoption will depend on end-client testing and modification requirements.

Valuation: reiterate Buy rating

After the recent share price correction, we think concerns about potential EU tariffs and near-term earnings pressure are largely priced in. The current share price implies limited upside from SST and AIDC products, in our view. Thus we think the current multiple of 17x 2027E PE is attractive. Sungrow remains our top pick among the BESS and AIDC themes. Key catalysts include the launch of SST products, AIDC BESS orders and a potential H-share listing.

Tech

Strengthening AI ecosystem and tech supply chain capability

UBS's World Artificial Intelligence Conference (WAIC) 2026 Tech Tour concluded in mid-July. We held C-level/IR meetings with 12 companies in LLM (MiniMax, Zhipu, Phancy and Xunce), GPU (Biren), networking (Montage and Xizhi), analog (Southchip and Dosilicon), OSAT (JCET), ODM (Huaqin) and semi equipment (PowerTech). We made multiple booth visits and attended keynote events. Notable takeaways: 1) strong interest: over 40 institutional investors participated in our tour and reportedly over 1,100 exhibitors and 400k+ attendees participated in WAIC 2026; 2) global collaboration: China announced the creation of WAICO (World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organization), involving 29 countries, and signed initiatives on AI governance. China signed cUS\$3bn of new contracts with overseas companies; 3) rapid progress in China LLM iteration, including Kimi K3 and Qwen 3.8-Max models; 4) evolving domestic AI infrastructure offerings including super computing (e.g. Biren), SuperPod (e.g. Huawei, Huaqin) and networking (e.g. Xizhi); and 5) positive feedback from the supply chain on AI infra-related end demand. The tour strengthened our confidence and improved visibility on the rapid growth of China's major AI tech supply chain companies in 2026E and beyond.

WAIC 2026: major AI related hardware/semi products/solutions showcased

AI infra computing and SuperPod. Huawei displayed its Atlas 950 SuperPod with 1,024 chips. Sugon showcased its SuperPoD solution, Sugon 8000, which enables 100k-chip interconnect. Other SuperPod products released include MetaX (XiJing S600), ZTE (OEX) and Alibaba (Panjiu AL128 empowered by Zhenwu M890). **Networking.** Xizhi released a 51.2T CPO switch prototype and showcased its full-stack optical interconnect solution. **Applications.** We noted edge AI applications across AI smartphone (ZTE's Nubia), AI workstations (e.g. Moore Threads' AIBOOK), autonomous driving (e.g. MetaX's robotaxi solution; BYD's self-designed Xuanji A3) and robotics.

Key takeaways from tech supply chain companies

Compute. Chinese AI accelerator companies noted stronger demand from domestic customers (including CSPs), due to tight supply in China and domestic CSP willingness to adopt domestic computing cards. For tier-2 AI accelerator suppliers, most are working on H100/H200 equivalent chips and iterate the SuperPod technology to overcome the challenges of single cards. **Networking.** Montage said DDR5 Gen3/4 memory interface chip contributions continue to increase in 2026, with Gen5 chip shipments likely in H226. The company flagged rising demand for CXL/MRDIMM from end customers. **Advanced packaging.** Including the ramp-up of its advanced packaging fab (JME) in Jiangyin, JCET recently announced it would build an advanced packaging fab in Shanghai with a total investment of Rmb7.8bn, indicating a strong demand outlook. The company is upbeat on the AI power related packaging business for overseas and domestic customers, and expects total TAM to increase multiple times in 2025-27F. **Analog.** Southchip noted muted demand from consumer electronics applications, while it is building advanced analog solutions to fulfil AI power and memory applications. **Server ODMs.** Huaqin reported stronger demand for data centre applications in 2026, mainly driven by switches, AI servers and SuperPod deployment.

Stock recommendations

Within China AI LLM, our top pick is Zhipu (positive fundamentals and an attractive valuation) and we have a Buy rating on MiniMax. In the AI related Chinese tech semiconductor supply chain, we prefer UBS APAC Key Call NAURA (Buy; WFE localisation), JCET (advanced packaging) and Han's Laser (PCB equipment). In China's hardware supply chain, we prefer Apple-related companies Luxshare, Lens Tech and AAC.

Key takeaways from corporate meetings

LLM and related companies

Knowledge Atlas Technology/ Zhipu (2513.HK, Buy)

ARR is ahead of plan with the recent H-share placement supporting compute ramp-up. Management said that Zhipu's ARR (annual recurring revenue) reached US \$1bn as of July, ahead of its 2026 year-end target, supported by both rapid token usage growth and API price increases. While compute power remains the key constraint, management believes the recent H-share placement (HK\$31bn) will drive compute expansion, and it is considering compute leasing as a way to leverage larger scale compute resources.

It expects price increases and inference optimisation to support margin expansion, while compute cost uncertainty remains a swing factor. Management said that API price increases and continued efforts in inference optimisation could support margin expansion, while acknowledging that the pace of margin improvement remains subject to compute leasing cost uncertainty, especially given tight domestic compute supply and rising rental prices.

Pursuing frontier model capability remains a key priority. Management reiterated that pursuing frontier model capability remains a key priority. Beyond parameter scaling, management also identified broader dimensions of scaling to support further intelligence improvement, including data, infrastructure and hardware capability.

MiniMax (0100.HK, Buy)

Accelerating ARR ramp amid strong API demand. Management said MiniMax's ARR continues to ramp quickly, from cUS\$100m at end-2025 to cUS\$150m announced at the Q1 earnings call, more than doubling prior to the M3 release, with management remaining confident in achieving its US\$1bn ARR target by end-2026. This is mainly driven by rapid growth in the API and Token Plan business, while 2C subscription revenue also remained solid. As a result, revenue contribution from API /Token Plan increased to nearly half of total revenue in May vs. c30% in 2025.

Multiple inference optimisation efforts to support healthy gross margin. Although MiniMax's latest flagship text model, M3, has nearly doubled parameter size vs. the M2.7, management said gross margin could remain healthy supported by continued inference engineering optimisation and refined cluster operations, in addition to benefits from early compute procurement.

Scaling up parameters further to pursue better model capability. With the proven path of parameter scaling from M2 to M3, management plans to scale up model parameters further and better leverage its compute resource advantages. In addition, management emphasised further model capability improvement through post-training, especially in coding capability.

AI hardware/semiconductor supply chain

Montage (6809.HK, Buy/688008.SH, Not Rated)

Management said demand remains strong, while near-term upside could be capped by supply constraints in upstream packaging materials such as BT substrate and e-glass cloth. Management expects the tightness to gradually ease from H226, although it should persist in the near term.

For RCD products, management expects a rapid ramp for DDR5 Gen3 and Gen4, with shipments of Gen5 starting in Q2. Among new product lines, MRCD/MDB (for MRDIMM) have become the key revenue contributors, although management expects meaningful volume growth when next-generation X86 CPU platforms ramp, likely in late 2026 or early 2027.

Management is engaged with ARM-based customers on MRDIMM adoption, while views SOCAMM as complementary rather than competitive with MRDIMM remaining the mainstream server memory solution due to its superior capacity and bandwidth. Management expects PCIe retimer to continue benefiting from rising 8-card AI server demand with PCIe retimer 6.0 qualification progressing well ahead of next-generation CPU launches and potentially offering more opportunities in overseas markets.

CXL MXC remains the key focus. Montage is working closely with customers to explore new applications such as the reuse of DDR4 memory to increase capacity, or memory pooling. The company expects broader commercialisation over the next two to three years with the ramp of CXL 3.0-enabled CPU platforms and a more mature ecosystem. Montage is eyeing Ethernet and optical interconnects as long term growth engines, leveraging its SerDes expertise, with Ethernet PHY to complete engineering sampling tape-out probably this year.

Montage participated in CXMT's IPO strategic placement, and we think this has strengthened the partnership in the long term and positioned the company to benefit from CXMT's capacity expansion and next-generation memory roadmap.

JCET (600584.SS, Buy)

Management remains constructive about the current upcycle, which differs fundamentally from previous cycles as it is supported by structural demand for AI. Utilisation rate remained at 80% in Q2, with AI-related businesses, wafer-level packaging and bumping all fully loaded. Management expects UTR to continue to improve even as new capacity comes online, and management expects GM to trend higher based on the favourable pricing environment.

The newly announced Rmb7.8bn investment plan will focus on 2.5D packaging. The company expects the fab to be completed in H228 and start production from 2029. Management believes it can capture a larger portion of the 2.5D packaging value chain, extending beyond oS packaging. We believe JCET is well positioned to benefit from both domestic AI accelerator ramp and spill over effect in overseas markets, supported by its technology capabilities, global customer base and growing opportunities from localisation.

Beyond 2.5D packaging, JCET is a global leader in AI PMIC assembly, which offers margins above the corporate average. For the WDC Shanghai fab, JCET expects 2026 revenue growth to be driven primarily by domestic memory capacity expansion.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

Our price target for Sungrow is based on DCF methodology.

Risks include: 1) slowing global solar and energy storage demand; 2) slower-than-expected inverter and EES cost reduction; 3) lower-than-expected inverter and EES ASP; 4) slower-than-expected progress of taking market shares; and 5) slower-than-expected on new capacity expansion progress.

Investing in the China technology sector involves a high degree of risk. Rapid technological changes, increasing competition and exposure to macroeconomic cycles are among the many risks faced by investors in tech stocks. Moreover, it is extremely difficult to project the financial results of tech companies, since their operating models are highly volatile and unpredictable. Finally, valuing tech stocks can prove challenging, as neither traditional nor non-traditional valuation measures provide much insight into how these stocks trade.

We value NAURA, Luxshare, Lens Tech, AAC Tech and Han's Laser using a PE methodology.

We value JCET using a PB methodology.

We adopt Price/ARR as our valuation methodology for MiniMax.

We adopt Price-to-sales (P/S) as our valuation methodology for Zhipu, cross checked with SOTP analysis.

Required Disclosures

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12-Month Rating	Definition	Coverage ¹	IB Services ²
Buy	FSR is > 6% above the MRA.	55%	24%
Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	40%	21%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 30 June 2026.

1:Percentage of companies under coverage globally within the 12-month rating category.

2:Percentage of companies within the 12-month rating category for which investment banking (IB) services were provided within the past 12 months.

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UBS AG Hong Kong Branch: Sharon Ding. **UBS Securities Co. Limited:** Cathy Fang, PhD, Gus Huang, CFA, Jay Song, Jimmy Yu, Mandy Liu, Robin Xu, Sky Hong, Yishu Yan.

Company Disclosures

Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
AAC Technologies ²⁸	2018.HK	Buy	HK\$42.90	14 Aug 2026
Han's Laser Technology Industry ^{13,4,6}	002008.SZ	Buy	Rmb99.00	14 Aug 2026
JCET Group	600584.SS	Buy	Rmb78.71	14 Aug 2026
Knowledge Atlas Technology ²⁸	2513.HK	Buy	HK\$1,270	14 Aug 2026
Lens Technology ^{28,18}	300433.SZ	Buy	Rmb35.74	14 Aug 2026
Luxshare Precision Industry ¹³	002475.SZ	Buy	Rmb56.58	14 Aug 2026
MiniMax Group ^{2,4,5,6,28}	0100.HK	Buy	HK\$329.00	14 Aug 2026
Montage Technology - H ^{2,4,5,6,28}	6809.HK	Buy	HK\$283.80	14 Aug 2026
NAURA Technology Group	002371.SZ	Buy	Rmb738.66	14 Aug 2026
Sungrow Power Supply	300274.SZ	Buy	Rmb116.72	14 Aug 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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